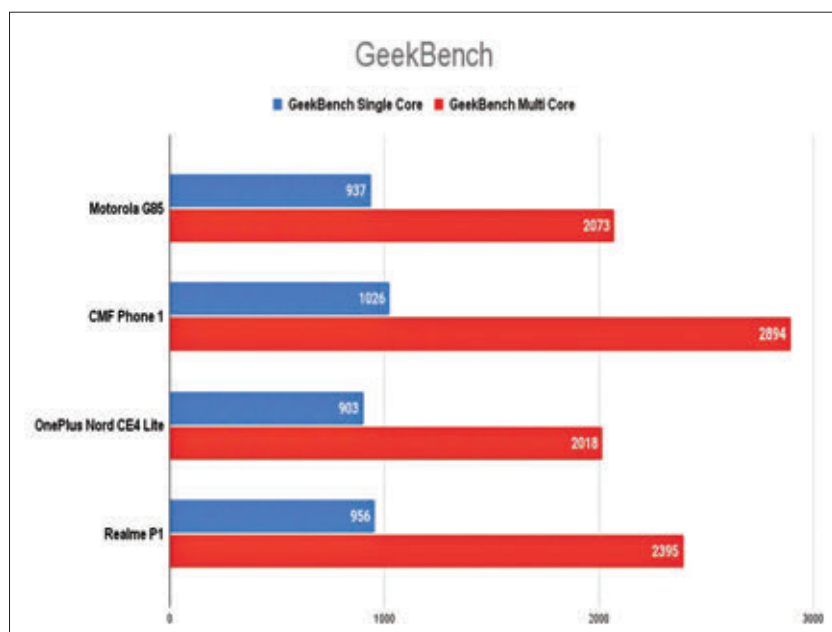




to the CMF Phone 1 and Realme P1. Fortunately, it doesn't throttle excessively; it only throttles to 80 per cent of its peak performance after 15 minutes of running the CPU Throttling Test, which is good.

In GPU benchmarks, the Motorola G85 falls significantly behind its competitors. The CMF Phone 1, priced at just ₹15,999, outperforms it in GPU performance by a significant margin, offering smoother gameplay for intensive games like BGMI or Call of Duty: Mobile.

On the bright side, the phone's UI is impressive. The Motorola G85 runs on Motorola's near-stock Android UI, known as Hello UI, which is clean and easy to navigate. While there are a few third-party apps, it's still less cluttered compared to the Realme P1. Motorola has also included some useful features such as Family Space and Moto Unplugged, which enhance the user experience. The Smart Connect feature, one of my personal favourites, allows you to mirror your phone on other devices like laptops or desktops, adding to its versatility.

CAMERA

The Motorola G85 boasts a dual-camera setup on the back, featuring a

50MP Sony LYT-600 primary sensor with Optical Image Stabilisation (OIS) and a secondary ultrawide camera that also doubles as a macro shooter. You also get a 32 MP front camera for shooting selfies.

The primary camera performs well in good lighting conditions, capturing detailed and vibrant images. The OIS helps in reducing blur, although it still struggles in low-light scenarios. Portrait photos look good with decent skin tone reproduction and good edge detection. The ultrawide camera could be better, as there are instances of HDR blooming in some shots, but it's decent for the price.

The front camera is adequate for selfies and video calls. It even captures close-to-natural skin tones, which surprised me.

Video recording is capped at 1080p at 60 fps, which is disappointing as the CMF Phone 1 overshadows it with 4K video support. But then again, the CMF Phone 1 misses out on an ultrawide shooter and instead opts for a depth shooter.

My biggest gripe here is the noisiness of low-light shots; the camera could be better optimised for this as I've seen phones with the Sony LYT-600 perform better in low light.

BATTERY LIFE

The Motorola G85 is equipped with a 5,000mAh battery, which provides mediocre battery life. This surprised me as budget Motorola phones usually have excellent battery endurance. With moderate usage, the phone provides 5.5 hours of screen-on time on a single charge. In our 4K video loop test, the phone only lasted 690 minutes or 11.5 hours, which is much lower than competitors like the CMF Phone 1 and OnePlus Nord CE4 Lite.

The 33W fast charging support is standard fare at this price point. It took 1 hour and 16 minutes for the phone to charge from 0-100 per cent, which is decent but it lags behind the OnePlus Nord CE4 Lite's 80 W charging speeds.

VERDICT

The Motorola G85 is a solid budget smartphone that stands out with its premium design, vibrant display, and decent camera setup. If you frequently consume content on your smartphone, the Motorola G85 is one of my top recommendations under ₹20,000 thanks to its superb display and stereo speakers. However, it does lag behind in raw performance compared to some competitors. So, if top-notch performance is your main priority, you might want to consider alternatives like the Realme P1 or CMF Phone 1. For those that prioritise battery life and fast charging, spending an additional ₹2,000 on the OnePlus Nord CE4 Lite could be worthwhile, though it also falls short in performance, similar to the Motorola G85.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Memory: 8 GB RAM and 128 GB ROM | Display: 16.94 cm (6.67 inch) Full HD+ Display | Battery: 5000 mAh | Processor: Qualcomm Snapdragon 6s Gen 3 | Cameras: 50MP + 8MP | 32MP Front Camera

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